# DEMO Enterprise Platform — questions you'll be asked

Short, honest answers for the demo with the CEO, CAO, Finance, HR, department managers and IT. Page 1: how it's built + leadership. Page 2: IT (front end, back end, data, security). Page 3: Finance, HR & payroll, managers — and what the demo does **not** do yet.

CEO · CAO · Finance · HR · Managers · IT

**The 30-second answer.** What you're seeing is a working **prototype**: every screen, role and approval rule Alderbrook Group needs, built and tested with fictional data. Going live means putting the same screens on a secure **server and database in Canada**, with **Microsoft sign-in**, real backups and **CRA-certified payroll** — about **130 working days** (Oct 19, 2026 → Apr 30, 2027) in three company waves, with two pay runs checked side-by-side before payroll switches over.

## How it's built — today vs. live

### Today: the demo — prototype · fictional data

**Front end**
Screens in plain JavaScript, built into one web page (42 code modules · ~15,600 lines).

→

**"Back end" rules**
162 actions (approve, post, pay…) — each checks the role, validates, writes the audit log.

→

**Data**
Saved in **this browser only**. Demo sign-in, no passwords.

**Why it matters**
The rules are already written the way a server runs them — they move to the server, they aren't rewritten from scratch.

### Live: the real system — proposed · built in step 3

**Front end**
Same screens, as a TypeScript web app. Works on phones. Keeps **no data** on the device.

→

**Back end — API**
Node.js/TypeScript server; the 162 actions become API calls with the **same permission checks**.

→

**Data**
PostgreSQL database + encrypted file storage, in a cloud region **in Canada**.

**Microsoft 365 sign-in + MFA**
One account; leavers lose access when IT disables it.

**Connections**
Email · bank EFT file · CRA payroll formulas · Excel/CSV.

FRONT END what runs in the browser · BACK END server rules & API · DATA database, files, migration · SECURITY access & privacy · OPERATIONS hosting, support, cost

## CEO & CAO — decision, money, risk

**Is this real software or a mock-up?**
Real software with fictional data. Every button works — approvals route, payroll calculates, journals post, files attach. What's missing is the secure server, real sign-in and real data, which is the build step.

**How long, and when do we see value?**
130 working days. Alderbrook Holdings goes live first (Feb 19, 2027), then Ridgeline Timber (Mar 5), then Silver Lake Lodges + Northbay Seafoods (Mar 19). First real payroll: Apr 12, 2027, after two side-by-side runs.

**What does it cost?**
Three parts: the build team (1–2 developers for ~6 months), cloud hosting (an estimated CAD $300–800 a month at our size — to be quoted in step 1), and staff time from HR, payroll and finance leads (~1 day a week). No per-user licence fees for the platform itself.

**What does it replace — and what does it save?**
Paper/email approvals, spreadsheets for leave and banked OT, separate HR, payroll and AP tools. Savings come from one sign-in, approvals in minutes, no re-keying between payroll and the books, and a full audit trail. Confirm the systems we switch off in step 2.

**What's the biggest risk?**
Paying people wrong. That's why payroll uses CRA-certified formulas and only goes live after two pay runs match the old system to the cent — the old system stays as the safety net.

**Who owns the code? What if the developer leaves?**
Agree it in the contract: Alderbrook Group gets the source code (private repository), the right to change it, and documentation. Standard technology (TypeScript, PostgreSQL) means any competent team can maintain it. Step 9 hands admin to Alderbrook Group IT.

**Is our data safe and in Canada?**
Yes — hosted in a cloud region in Canada, encrypted in transit and at rest, Microsoft sign-in with MFA, role-based access, every action in an audit log. Built to BC PIPA; an independent security test runs before go-live.

**Can it grow with us — new companies, new rules?**
Yes. Four companies today; each record carries its company, so adding a fifth is a settings change. Approval limits, menus and wording change from Administration screens, without code.

The demo can also be shown as one company — Alderbrook Holdings with the same eight departments, people and approvals — chosen on its first page.

# IT Manager — the technical questions

Front end, back end, data, security and operations. “Proposed” means the recommendation for the live build; the final choices are confirmed with IT in steps 1–2.

IT Manager

## Front end — what runs in the browser

**FE What is the demo built with?**
Plain JavaScript modules (no framework), HTML and CSS, compiled by a small build script into one self-contained page (~8.2 MB incl. sample data and how-to images). It runs in any modern browser with nothing installed.

**FE What will the live front end be?**
Proposed: the same screens moved to a TypeScript web app (React) served from the cloud over HTTPS. The browser only displays data and sends actions — nothing sensitive is stored on the device.

**FE Phones and tablets? Offline for crews?**
Layouts already adapt to phone width — approvals, timesheets and requests work on a phone browser. No native app; offline timesheet entry for camps with no signal is a phase-2 option.

**FE Browsers, accessibility, theming?**
Current Chrome, Edge, Safari and Firefox. Keyboard and screen-reader labels on controls, light/dark themes, readable font sizes. A formal WCAG 2.1 AA check is part of testing.

## Back end — server, API, business rules

**BE Is there a back end today?**
Not a separate server — the demo runs its “server” rules inside the page. They're written as 162 actions, each one: check permission → validate → change data → write audit. That's exactly the shape of an API, so they port across rather than being redesigned.

**BE Proposed back-end stack?**
Node.js + TypeScript API (same language as the front end, so rules are shared), PostgreSQL, encrypted object storage for attachments, a job queue for emails, reminders and bank files. Containerised, deployed to Azure Canada.

**BE How are permissions enforced?**
On the server, for every action — never just by hiding buttons. 13 roles with grants (e.g. ap.approve), scoped to company. Menus already show only what the server would allow; the automated test checks every role against every page (176 routes).

**BE APIs and integrations?**
Planned: a documented REST API (not in the demo). First connections: Microsoft 365 (sign-in, email), bank direct-deposit/EFT file (CPA-005), CRA payroll formulas, Excel/CSV import and export. Live bank feeds need a bank-data provider agreement.

**BE How do approvals and workflows work?**
A rules table per request type (the supervisor first, then director level above a threshold; Finance processes it after). The engine resolves the next approver, notifies them, records each decision with comment, and posts results (e.g. bill → journal). Admins edit thresholds on screen.

**BE How is it tested?**
Automated browser tests sign in as every role and click through every page and workflow — the full demo script (62 steps) runs end-to-end with zero errors. The live build adds unit tests, payroll checks against CRA's PDOC calculator, and a pen test.

## Data, security & operations

**DATA Where does demo data go today?**
Only into the presenter's browser storage — fictional people, nothing sent anywhere. Never type real names, SINs or pay into the demo or the Netlify copy.

**DATA How is the data modelled?**
Every change is an event (who, what, when) applied to tables — so history and the audit log come for free. ~80 record types: employees, timesheets, pay runs, accounts, journals, bills, POs, projects, files.

**DATA How do we migrate our data?**
From Excel/CSV exports of today's systems: staff, vendors, chart of accounts, opening balances, leave and banked OT, year-to-date pay. Two trial loads; totals must match the old books before go-live.

**SECURITY Sign-in, MFA, leavers?**
Microsoft Entra ID (your Microsoft 365 accounts) single sign-on with MFA. Disable the account in Microsoft and access ends. Roles are assigned in the app by an administrator; every change is logged.

**SECURITY Sensitive fields — SIN, bank, pay?**
Encrypted in the database and masked on screen (e.g. ••••2239). Pay and SIN visible only to HR/payroll roles. Files open only for roles that can see the record — AP files need AP access.

**OPS Backups, uptime, disaster recovery?**
Managed database with daily backups and point-in-time restore; files replicated within Canada. Monitoring and alerts; target 99.9% uptime; restore tested before go-live. Records kept 6+ years for CRA.

**OPS Performance and scale?**
Sized for hundreds of users across four companies; indexed database queries and paged lists. A load test with a year of real-volume data is part of step 5.

**OPS Support and updates after go-live?**
Agree a support plan (response times, a test environment, monthly updates). Releases go to a staging copy first; Alderbrook Group IT gets admin access, runbooks and the source repository.

# Finance, HR & managers — and the honest gaps

What each department will ask, then the list of things the demo doesn't do yet — say these before someone else finds them.

Finance | HR & Payroll | Managers

## Finance

**Does it replace our accounting system?**
It covers the general ledger, AP, AR, banking and reconciliation, budgets, fixed assets, inter-company and month-end close for all four companies, with GST. Decide in step 2 whether it replaces the current package or feeds it.

**How do bills, POs and payments flow?**
Purchase order request → approval → printed PO → goods received → bill (with its invoice files) → 3-way match → approval → payment batch → one journal entry. Each step links to the next and is in the audit log.

**Can anyone change a posted entry or a closed month?**
No. Posted journals are reversed, not edited, and a closed period refuses back-dated entries. Who did what, and when, is always on record — auditors can be given view-only access.

**Reports and exports?**
Trial balance, P&L and balance sheet by company and group, budgets vs actual, project budget vs spent. Most lists download as Excel, PDF or CSV.

## HR & Payroll

**Is the payroll calculation CRA-correct?**
Not in the demo — its tax figures are illustrative. The live build uses CRA-certified formulas (federal + BC, CPP/CPP2, EI) checked against CRA's PDOC, then two real pay runs side-by-side before switching.

**T4s, ROEs, remittances?**
T4 boxes build from posted pay runs; ROEs draft from end-of-employment; PD7A remittances are tracked to their due dates. In the demo these are produced for filing by hand (ROE Web, CRA) — electronic filing is a later step.

**Who can see salaries and SINs?**
HR and payroll roles only. Managers see their team's time, leave and reviews — not pay. Employees see their own pay statements, T4 and documents.

**BC rules — overtime, stat holidays, banked time?**
Daily and weekly overtime (1.5× after 8 h / 40 h, 2× after 12 h), stat holidays, and banked OT with an 8-hour daily limit are built in and shown on timesheets and balances. Settings are per company.

## Department managers

**How much extra work is this for me?**
Less: one Approvals page for timesheets, time off, expenses, purchases and travel — approve with a note, from a phone. Hiring requests and new projects are one form each, with status you can see.

**What if I'm away — who approves?**
If you're on approved full-day time off when a request is sent, it also goes to your own manager — the first decision counts. A “delegate my approvals while I'm away” setting is on the build list (not in the demo).

## Say it straight — what the demo does not do yet (all in the build plan)

- No server, real sign-in or passwords — data stays in one browser
- Payroll tax is illustrative, not CRA-certified
- No direct-deposit (EFT/CPA-005) bank file yet
- No electronic filing to CRA / Service Canada
- Emails are simulated inside the app, not sent
- No live bank feeds — statements are imported
- No open API for other systems yet
- Dollars (CAD) only; English only
- No native phone app or offline mode
- No approval delegation setting for holidays

## Questions to ask them back

- Which systems and spreadsheets do we switch off — and when do their contracts end?
- Do we keep the current accounting package, or replace it?
- Who is the champion in each company, and who signs off each checkpoint?
- Must payroll go live before the 2027 tax year starts, or after year-end?

## If you don't know the answer

- “Good question — that's decided in step 2 (Discover & map); I'll note it.”
- Never promise a date, price or integration on the spot — write it down.
- Show, don't tell: open the screen in the demo (press / to search).
- Keep the parking-lot list and send it with the rollout plan after the meeting.